

IK 560: Vaiṣṇavism: History, Teachings and Practice

Course Code	IK 560
Course Name	Vaiṣṇavism: History, Teachings and Practice
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	BTech/MTech/MS/MSc/MA/Ph.D
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	42nd Senate (Jan 2024)

Course Contents

- **Introduction to Vaishnavism:** Historical evolution; Core beliefs and practices; Overview of key scriptures and teachers. (6 Hours)
- **Vaishnavism in the Vedic and Upanishadic Period:** Vedic references to Viṣṇu; Concepts of Nārāyaṇa in Upaniṣads in Upanishads; Early beginnings and foundations. (6 Hours)
- **The Epics and Puranic Vaishnavism:** Rāmāyaṇa and Mahabharata's influence; Stories of Vishnu's avatars; Puranic traditions and stories. (8 Hours)
- **Philosophical Foundations:** The Vedanta traditions of Rāmānuja, Madhva, and others; Concept of Bhakti (devotion); Viśiṣṭādvaita, Dvaita, and other schools of thought. (7 Hours)
- **Vaiṣṇava Practices, Rituals, and Festivals:** Daily rituals, temple worship, and pilgrimages; Festivals like Janmāṣṭamī, Rāma Navamī, and others; Role of music, dance, and art in Vaiṣṇavism. (7 Hours)
- **Modern Movements and Global Presence:** Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavism and ISKCON; The spread of Vaiṣṇavism outside India; Contemporary challenges and contributions. (8 Hours)

Laboratory Modules

- NA

Text Books

1. Bhatia, V., **Unforgetting Chaitanya: Vaishnavism and cultures of devotion in colonial Bengal**, Oxford University Press, 2017.
2. Flood, G., **An Introduction to Hinduism**, Cambridge University Press, 2004.

References

1. Rocher, L., **The Puranas**, Otto Harrassowitz Verlag, 1986.
2. Thapar, R., **Chandragupta II and the Rise of Vaishnavism. Religion and World Civilizations** [3 volumes]: How Faith Shaped Societies from Antiquity to the Present [3 volumes], 68, 2023.